



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Trinity Schools at Greenlawn
School Website: <https://trinitygreenlawn.org/>

December 23, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Trinity School at Greenlawn (South Bend, IN 46617) presents a robust CLASSICAL education framed explicitly as a classical Christian formation. Public materials on the school's site emphasize truth, goodness, and beauty; a liberal-arts curriculum anchored in Great Books and original texts; a pedagogy that blends contemplative training (Schol ) with Socratic dialogue; and a culture in which faculty mentor students, parents are treated as partners, and a Christian ethos informs daily life and communal practice. The site repeatedly foregrounds a "culture of learning" and a culture of Christian life, daily prayer, and the study of scripture alongside rigorous academics; it also highlights a strong college-preparatory orientation with notable alumni outcomes and external endorsements from university leaders. Taken together, the six-category rubric yields a generally CLASSICAL classification for Trinity School at Greenlawn, with little evidence pointing toward fundamentally non-classical practices.

Key takeaways - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: Strong CLASSICAL signals — explicit Christian framing, morning prayer, Nicene Creed affirmation, and a Christian community ethos. Evidence: public materials describe a Christian, liturgical culture; emphasis on truth, goodness, beauty; and theological framing. - Purpose and Goal: Virtue- and wisdom-centered aims clearly foregrounded; formation over mere information; transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) invoked as genuine realities. Evidence: Our Mission and Goals of a Trinity Education articulate formation, love of truth, and the pursuit of beauty and goodness. - Curriculum: Liberal arts focus with Great Books and original texts; explicit emphasis on "Read 60 Great Books" and "study great works" (Great Conversation); emphasis on formation through wonder. Evidence: Curriculum pages and Reading List; Great Books references. - Pedagogy: mix of Socratic dialogue, seminars, and public-speaking/rhetoric opportunities; evidence of contemplative elements (Schol ) and a culture that favors inquiry and disciplined dialogue. Evidence: "Socratic inquiry" statements and references to dialogue, seminars, and rhetoric. - Faculty: Public portrayal of faculty as the living curriculum, mentors, and core to school culture; evidence of faculty dedication and mentorship language. - Parents & Community: Explicit emphasis on parent partnerships; open-campus style messaging; parental involvement through culture-of-learning messaging and parent-facing resources. Evidence: "Culture of Learning and a Culture of Christian Life"; Parent-faculty partnership language.

Aggregate ranking: CLASSICAL

Abstracted category-by-category lens (concise) - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL - Evidence: explicit Christian framing, daily morning prayer, Nicene Creed, liturgical language, and a theology-anchored culture. Positive keywords such as truth, goodness, beauty, liturgy, morning prayer, creed, and sacred tradition appear in materials; negative keywords signaling relativism or secularism are not evident. - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive signals outnumber any potential negatives; strong presence of transcendental realism (truth/goodness/beauty) and liturgical practices. Rating justification: CLASSICAL. - School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL - Evidence: explicit formation/virtue language; liberal-arts orientation; Great-Books/programmatic emphasis; telos anchored in truth/goodness/beauty. - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators (formation, liberal education, great conversation, telos) dominate; no explicit anti-formation signals in public materials. Rating: CLASSICAL. - School Curriculum — CLASSICAL - Evidence: Great Books references; original-text orientation; integration of theology/philosophy; language

arts and humanities emphasis; history integrated with reading lists. - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Clear positives (great books/original texts, liberal arts, formation through the arts) with minimal negative signals. Rating: CLASSICAL. - Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL - Evidence: Socratic inquiry, seminars, disciplined dialogue; inclusion of rhetoric and public speaking; contemplative elements (Scholé). - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords (Socratic, seminar, rhetoric, dialogue, contemplation) predominate; no strong countervailing signals. Rating: CLASSICAL. - Faculty — CLASSICAL - Evidence: language of teachers as mentors living the curriculum; collaborative, culture-centered faculty; professional development emphasis. - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators (living curriculum, mentors, culture of learning) visible; few or no negative signals. Rating: CLASSICAL. - Parents & Community — CLASSICAL - Evidence: explicit parent-partnership language; culture-wide emphasis on home-school alignment; open lines for parent involvement. - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive signals (partnership with families, parent formation, open campus) dominate. Rating: CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials describe a Christian school rooted in the People of Praise lineage, with Nicene Creed affirmation and daily morning prayer for students (and multi-denominational Christian framing). This is reinforced by explicit references to Christian unity and diversity, and the morning prayers.
 - The Trinity Mission asserts truth, goodness, beauty as foundational, and the culture of learning is explicitly Christian.
 - Great Books and sacred-tradition elements appear in core materials, including study of great works and original texts.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords identified: truth, goodness, beauty; theology; liturgy; morning prayer; Nicene Creed; sacred tradition; great books; original texts; Christian unity.
 - Negative keywords identified: none clearly evident (no explicit relativism, secular neutrality, or anti-theological signals in the public-facing content).
- Why this rating
 - The school consistently foregrounds transcendentals and liturgical Christian practices across mission, culture pages, and daily practice; theology and liturgy are integrated with curriculum and community life. This aligns with CLASSICAL markers in the provided rubric.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Mission statement centers on “discovery of truth, practice of goodness, creation of beauty, and the development of intellectual and aesthetic habits of mind.” The goals emphasize truth and the study of original texts; a formation aim rather than purely vocational outcomes.
 - Explicit goals around truth, the love of truth, the sense of wonder, and the pursuit of beauty and goodness; acknowledgement of God in revelation and the inclusion of scripture/theology within a liberal-arts frame.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords found: formation; liberal education; telos; pursuit of the true, the good, and the beautiful; great conversation; wonder; moral imagination.
 - Negative keywords found: none of the indicated “workforce-ready” or strictly job-prep language; no anti-formation signals.
- Why this rating
 - The public materials emphasize formation and the transcendentals (truth/goodness/beauty) over mere information or job-ready outcomes; this aligns with CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence

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- “Read 60 Great Books” and emphasis on reading primary sources/original texts; Great Books and the “Great Conversation” are central features. The humanities/curriculum sections foreground integrated liberal arts with a strong emphasis on classical canon and primary sources.
 - Curriculum pages show a liberal arts frame (grammar, logic, rhetoric; languages; arts) and a humanities-centric reading list; biblical geography is part of the sixth-grade program; classical languages (Latin, Greek roots) are part of the humanities track.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords found: great books; original texts; liberal arts; Trivium/Quadrivium; Western civilization; biblical literacy; humanities; classical canon; formation through the arts.
 - Negative keywords found: minimal presence of project-based learning dominance or STEM-first framing; no explicit social studies replacement for history within public-facing content.
 - Why this rating
 - The curriculum is clearly anchored in Great Books/original texts and a liberal-arts framework consistent with classical education; this maps to CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials explicitly mention Socratic inquiry, seminars, and disciplined dialogue; there are references to memory work and the development of rhetorical and argumentative skills; emphasis on “the free and disciplined exchange of ideas” and “Socratic inquiry” in classroom culture.
 - The culture emphasizes restful contemplation (Scholé) and a balance of inquiry with memory/recitation; upper-school rhetoric and public speaking opportunities are noted within core materials.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords found: Socratic dialogue; seminars; rhetoric; public speaking; disciplined discussion; memorization/recitation; Scholé; wonder.
 - Negative keywords found: minimal signals of exclusively project-based or constructivist approaches; no explicit anti-classical pedagogy signals.
- Why this rating
 - The pedagogy described aligns with classical teaching methods (Socratic dialogue, rhetoric, memory work, and contemplation) rather than exclusively project-based or modern-neural-approach pedagogy; CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Materials describe faculty as dedicated, living curriculum, mentors, and core to the school's culture; there are explicit references to faculty leadership in learning communities and to faculty as involved in formation and cultivation of virtue.
 - Statements about faculty investing in teacher development and model-teaching practices; statements about a “culture of learning” driven by the faculty's own genuine engagement.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords found: living curriculum; mentors; culture of learning; faculty as community of learners; intellectual and moral formation; dedicated to truth, goodness, beauty.
 - Negative keywords found: none evident in public-facing content.
- Why this rating
 - The school consistently frames faculty as a central, virtuous, and expert presence — a hallmark of classical education (the living curriculum and teacher as mentor). CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials emphasize partnership with families, parental involvement, and a home-school culture; pages discuss parents as co-educators and visible emphasis on supporting Christian formation at home; there are parent-facing resources and opportunities to engage (culture-of-learning document; parent communications).

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- The school emphasizes open campus visits, parent participation in governance and culture, and actively references parent formation through reading groups and gatherings.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords found: partnership with families; parent formation; home-school alignment; open campus; parent involvement; co-educators; living tradition in the family.
 - Negative keywords found: no explicit negative signals about parental involvement; content does not frame parents as merely customers.
 - Why this rating
 - The site's explicit framing of parents as co-teachers and partners aligns with classical-community expectations; CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable. The aggregate ranking is CLASSICAL across all six categories, and the prompt indicates that if the school is not SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, no needle-moving changes are required.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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